

Profile

Personal information

Name	INEZA, Odon
Share different name	No
Birthdate	01/04/2005

Contact details

Email, Phone	inezaodon1@gmail.com, +250.079-144-7468, Mobile, No other telephone
Permanent address	KK 25 Ave Kigali, RWA

Demographics

Gender Identity	Male
Sex	Male
Pronouns	He/Him

Language

English	Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home
Rwanda, Kinyarwanda	First Language, Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home
French	Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home
Swahili	Speak, Read, Write

Geography and nationality

Citizenship status	Citizen of non-U.S. country
Birthplace	Nyagatare, Rwanda 0 years US
Other citizenships	Rwanda
Current US Visa	None
Intended US Visa	F-1 Student

Common App fee waiver

Fee waiver requested Yes, Signed: Odon INEZA

Family

Household

Parents	Married
Home	Both Parents

Parent 1

Mother

Name	Yvette Mukabisanana
Email, Phone	bisananawarubibi@gmail.com, +250.788676512, Mobile
Occupation	Lawyer (attorney) or judge, Self-Employed
Education	Some college/university Associates (2006), Kigali Independant University, Rwanda,Kigali,Kicukiro,Kagarama, Kigali, Rwanda

Parent 2

Father

Name	Andre Butera
Email, Phone	andrebutera5@gmail.com, Mobile
Occupation	Accountant or actuary, Retired
Education	Some college/university Associates (2004), Universite de Zaire, Congo

Siblings

Sabin Butera, Age 23
Aubin Butera Ishema, Age 22
Gabin Ituze, Age 17
Gladys Muziranenge Aneze, Age 15

Education

Current or most recent secondary school

Ecole des Sciences Byimana, VP3V+HCP, Byimana, Ruhango District, Southern Province, Rwanda, Religious (01/2020 - 08/2023)

Boarding school	Yes: Not living at school
Progression	Did or will take gap year
Graduation Date	08/2023

Colleges & universities

Grades

Rank	3 / 38, Weighted
GPA	87.8 / 100, Weighted

Current or most recent year courses

First trimester	Second trimester	Third trimester
MATH - Advanced Mathematics - (ADV)	MATH - Advanced Mathematics - (ADV)	MATH - Advanced Mathematics - (ADV)
PHYS - Advanced Physics - (ADV)	PHYS - Advanced Physics - (ADV)	PHYS - Advanced Physics - (ADV)
COMPSCI - Advanced Computer Science - (ADV)	COMPSCI - Advanced Computer Science - (ADV)	COMPSCI - Advanced Computer Science - (ADV)
OTH/ELE - Entrepreneurship - (ADV)	OTH/ELE - Entrepreneurship - (ADV)	OTH/ELE - Entrepreneurship - (ADV)
OTH/ELE - General Studies and Communication Skills - (ADV)	OTH/ELE - General Studies and Communication Skills - (ADV)	OTH/ELE - General Studies and Communication Skills - (ADV)
OTH/ELE - Scientific Drawing - (ADV)	OTH/ELE - Scientific Drawing - (ADV)	OTH/ELE - Scientific Drawing - (ADV)
RELG - Religious Studies - (ENRCHD)	RELG - Religious Studies - (ENRCHD)	RELG - Religious Studies - (ENRCHD)
ENG - English - (ADV)	ENG - English - (ADV)	ENG - English - (ADV)
LANG - French - (ADV)	LANG - French - (ADV)	LANG - French - (ADV)
LANG - Kinyarwanda - (ADV)	LANG - Kinyarwanda - (ADV)	LANG - Kinyarwanda - (ADV)

Honors

#1 in Maths and CS National Exams	National	12
Top 5 in Rwanda Math Competition	National	11, 12
East African Debate Championship Finalist	International	11
Distinguished Student of the 2022-2023 School Year	School	12
Won Spokesperson for Students with Disabilities Award during Inspire, Empower, and Educate Bootcamp	National	Post-graduate

Community-based organizations

CBO 1	EducationUSA
Counselor	Mr. Jean de Dieu Hakorimana
Email, Phone	educationusakigali@state.gov
CBO 2	Sonrise Mentorship Program (University of Michigan)
CBO 3	Kigali Preparatory Center

Future plans

Computer programmer or analyst, Doctorate

Testing

SAT tests

Evidence-based Reading and Writing	740	12/07/2024
Math	800	12/07/2024
Taken	1	
Planned	0	
SAT Essay	No	

Duolingo English Test

Literacy	145	10/13/2024
Comprehension	150	10/13/2024
Conversation	150	10/13/2024
Production	145	10/13/2024
Duolingo Total	150	10/13/2024
Taken	2	
Planned	0	

Leaving Exams

Mathematics	A	08/2023, Actual, NESA
Physics	A	08/2023, Actual, NESA
Computer Science	A	08/2023, Actual, NESA
Entrepreneurship	A	08/2023, Actual, NESA
General Studies & Comm	S	08/2023, Actual, NESA

Activities

Internship

9, 10, 11, 12, PG
Break
10 hr/wk, 5 wk/yr
Continue

Full-Stack Software Developer, Treasurer, Anti-Drug Organization Rwanda (ADOR)

Maintained Linux servers; developed website, www.ador.rw; monitored finances; oversaw street kids' shelter building project, housing 100+ kids today

Internship

PG
Year
6 hr/wk, 45 wk/yr
Continue

Back-End Developer, Pivot Access Rwanda

Contributed on driving license exams' queuing systems; managed microservice communication using Spring Boot, Linkerd, and Kubernetes

Other Club/Activity

10, 11, 12
School
3 hr/wk, 41 wk/yr
Continue

Co-founder, Trainer, Byimana Quantum Chess Club

Organized tournaments; Led creation of an interactive online platform that simulated quantum chess scenarios; qualified for national competitions

Science/Math

PG
Year
5 hr/wk, 35 wk/yr
Continue

Coach, Rwanda Informatics Olympiad

Coached and mentored students; coordinated inter-school informatics olympiads; had 300+ tutoring hours

Community Service (Volunteer)

11, 12
School
7 hr/wk, 41 wk/yr
Continue

President, Ecole des Sciences Byimana Statistics Club

Executed 5 school surveys; trained 50 members on using SPSS & NVivo; grew the club community from 12 to 90+ members; won Best Innovative Student award

Debate/Speech

9, 10, 11, 12, PG
School
6 hr/wk, 41 wk/yr
Continue

Debater/Coach/Judge, iDebate Rwanda & Byimana Debate Team
Competed in countrywide and regional tournaments; national debate team finalist; coached younger debaters; organized and judged in-school debates

Religious

10, 11, 12
School
3 hr/wk, 45 wk/yr
Continue

Sonorization Team Leader, Ecole des Science Byimana School Chapel
Raised funds for new speakers; monitored sound equipment usage and lease; DJ-ed Christian concerts; participated and taught liturgical studies class

Student Govt./Politics

11, 12
School
7 hr/wk, 45 wk/yr
Continue

Vice-Head boy, Ecole des Science Byimana
Monitored school sick bay; ensured smooth access to hospitals outside of school; bought 20 brooms, and dustbins; created the school nurse's database

Community Service (Volunteer)

PG
Year
12 hr/wk, 30 wk/yr
Continue

Teaching Assistant, Teaching Assistantship Project by Inspire, Empower, and Educate Rwanda
Initiated fundraising to pay school fees for 2 orphans; repaired an old lady's house; compiled physics curriculum into soft notes; taught village kids

Athletics: JV/Varsity

9, 10, 11, 12
Year
5 hr/wk, 50 wk/yr
Continue

Tennis, School Team Captain, Ecole des Science Byimana
Coached U-15 players training; three-time school MVP; national inter-school competitions finalist; won 2 major regional tournaments

Writing

Personal essay

The lessons we take from obstacles we encounter can be fundamental to later success. Recount a time when you faced a challenge, setback, or failure. How did it affect you, and what did you learn from the experience?

My words used to lag more frequently than a YouTube video over a spotty Wi-Fi connection. Every conversation was like negotiating a minefield of syllables because I stutter, so growing up was like having my own little speaking obstacle course. Naturally, this led to a number of not-so-creative nicknames and an excessive number of "Did you forget your lines?" jokes directed at me.

Imagine the story twist that resulted from my decision to join the debate club in high school. You may be wondering why a stutterer would voluntarily participate in speaking contests with fast-paced speech. Because it was like binge-watching a compelling drama for me to watch individuals make perfect arguments. It was captivating, similar to witnessing someone write a whole application without any errors.

It was like entering a different universe when you walked into that first argument meeting. With the assurance of a TED Talk speaker, everyone talked, but I was over here attempting to avoid tripping over "hello." Not only was my comfort zone expanded, but it was thrown into the stratosphere. Fighting a stammer while attempting to make a cogent point was like attempting to solve a Rubik's Cube while wearing a blindfold. So I persisted. Every discussion was like leveling up in a video game, with tougher opponents, greater obstacles, and better loot in the form of stronger eloquence and confidence. I discovered ways to manage my stutter, such as regulating my breathing, speaking slowly, and even interjecting a humorous quip at the right moment to defuse the situation.

As the weeks stretched into months, an odd thing occurred. I began concentrating more on developing strong arguments and less on stumbling over words. My passion was propelled by the same adrenaline that had previously driven my worry. I discovered I hadn't stammered once during a heated argument on whether pineapple belongs on pizza—it definitely does, by the way. It seemed as though giving the moment my whole attention eliminated any space for my previous speech patterns.

I dabbled in coding during my third year of high school. I became captivated. Learning computer languages felt a lot like learning debating. Both required painstaking attention to detail and a talent for solving problems. One missed semicolon may cause a computer to crash, just as one incorrect phrase could ruin an entire argument. Coding involves creating algorithms to solve issues, whereas debate involves creating arguments to persuade. Both demand that you foresee objections or errors and take aggressive measures to fix them. The thrill of a successful rebuttal is unmatched, let's face it, with the possible exception of locating the elusive bug that has been causing your software to crash for hours.

My new debate platform was coding, but this time I was debating computers. Evidence and rebuttals were replaced by variables and functions. Learning Python after JavaScript was similar to learning French after becoming proficient in English in that both need different syntax and mental acrobatics.

When I think back on my path, I can see that persistence was the key to success from the beginning. I learned from getting over my stutter that barriers are only temporary detours, not final destinations. This change in perspective made learning complicated programming languages seem more like an intriguing puzzle to solve than a drudgery. Who knew that the debating club's combative language would prepare me for line-of-code wrestling?

Additional information

"It's hard to fight when the fight ain't fair." This quote reminds me of what happened in Congo in 2021. When I reached my Aunt Betty's house, I was so shocked at the scene: kids roaming around on the streets, half-naked. They were walking, not knowing what to do, hungry and helpless, and I felt a sharp pang of helplessness. I had saved enough money for a three-day stay, but I realized quickly that whatever I could offer was just a drop in the bucket. It wasn't nearly enough to make a meaningful difference for those children or others in similar circumstances.

Talking with Aunt Betty later that evening, I began to understand what lay behind these heartwrenching scenes. She explained how corruption had seeped into every layer of the government, taking away from resources that should have gone to education, healthcare, and infrastructure. While people in major cities might not feel these effects as strongly, rural communities bear the full weight of it. The poverty and suffering I saw around me were not the result of an unavoidable economic condition but rather the direct consequence of officials who put personal gain over public welfare.

As I reflected, I realized the fight against corruption was inherently unfair. With no mechanism to hold officials accountable, they operated behind an opaque curtain. Poor data monitoring and lack of transparency enabled them to hide their actions with ease. I understood then that access to information is a powerful tool—it could enable communities to track government activities and question misuse. And I knew that I wanted to be a part of making that happen.

To address this issue, I'd like to propose a policy mandating government spending in African nations to be transparently tracked in a publicly accessible, centralized data system. Imagine a platform designed to simplify government budgets, expenditures, and resource allocations, presenting them in clear and easily navigable terms. Citizens would be able to monitor government spending at a local, regional, and national level and receive notifications for any unusual fluctuations in financial activities. Think of it as a "watchdog in your pocket"—an app or platform that puts power into the hands of everyday citizens by allowing them to access real-time information on where funds are going.

Implementing such a system would require collaboration between data scientists, programmers, policymakers, and activists. But the impact could be profound. Not only would it enable citizens to monitor how resources are being used, but it would also make it harder for officials to hide corrupt practices. When data becomes visible and accessible, accountability becomes a natural consequence. The platform could even incorporate visualizations to show budget allocations, spending breakdowns, and trends in resource use, empowering people with knowledge they can act on.

This could also be an educative policy in that through proper understanding, even those without technical backgrounds, it would make certain that the spirit of civic engagement through its information builds a culture of transparency in its simplicity. Working for the development of this platform, placing my data science and programming competencies in place, together with data

scientists and policy advocates, is something that I look to with anticipation in the future.

While standing in the face of the war on corruption might be a challenge, I will not stand by and watch injustices proliferate. Hopefully, data science for transparency will enable us to build a future in which governments are responsible and citizens have a say. This idea represents my contribution toward the world I wish there was; a world where the fight is fair; a world I will contribute to making.

Education progression

Details

Education progression details Did or will take gap year

Required explanation

Education progression

After graduating from high school, I was selected among the best 30 candidates to join the EducationUSA Scholars Program. This is a program that prepares high-achieving students who wish to pursue their education in the United States by guiding them throughout the whole application process and recommending them to schools.

Courses & Grades

Courses & Grades not completed

I understand that some colleges that require Courses & Grades may view my application as incomplete.

Course levels legend

REG - Regular/standard

ACC - Accelerated

ADV - Advanced

AP - Advanced placement

Cambridge AICE AS A-Level - AS/A-level/International A-level, Cambridge AICE

C PREP - College prep

DUAL - Dual enrollment

ENRCHD - Enriched

Cambridge IGCSE - GCSE, IGCSE

GFTED - Gifted

HGH HNR - High honors

HON - Honors

INTSV - Intensive

IB - International Baccalaureate

PRE IB - Pre-international Baccalaureate

RGNTS - Regents

N/A - Not applicable

Non-numeric/letter grade legend

I - Incomplete

NG - No grade

F - Fail (Pass/Fail)

P - Pass (Pass/Fail)

S - Satisfactory

U - Unsatisfactory

W - Withdrawn

WF - Withdrawn (Failed)

ME - Medical excuse

Grade 9

No courses reported.

Grade 10

No courses reported.

Grade 11

No courses reported.

Grade 12

No courses reported.

Other courses

No courses reported.

Stanford University questions

General

Entry Term	Fall 2025
Decision Plan	Regular Decision
Fee Waivers	I do not meet any of these criteria.
Citizenship	Citizen of non-U.S. country
Financial Aid	Yes, I intend to pursue need-based financial aid from Stanford.
Interview Interest	Yes, I am interested in an optional interview. I understand that if my school is not in a Stanford interview location that I will not be contacted. I also understand that there may not be enough alumni volunteers in my area so I may not be contacted for an interview. In both scenarios, I understand my application will be complete without an interview.
Arts Portfolio Interest	No
ACT/SAT Scores	Yes
Birth Country	Rwanda
Birth city	Nyagatare
Years lived in U.S.	0
Years lived outside U.S.	20
Agree that work submitted is my own	I affirm that the work submitted in my application is ultimately my own.

Academics

First Academic Interest	Computer Science
Second Academic Interest	Economics
Third Academic Interest	Public Policy

Contacts

Previously applied	No
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Family

Siblings applying	No
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Have any relatives ever enrolled in an undergraduate or graduate degree program at Stanford University?	No
Have any relatives ever been employed by Stanford University?	No
Parent different address	No
Number of parents	2
PARENT 1 INFORMATION	Mother
First Name	Yvette
Last Name	Mukabisanana
Occupation	Lawyer (attorney) or judge
Job Title	Lawyer
Employment Status	Self-Employed
PARENT 2 INFORMATION	Father
First Name	Andre
Last Name	Butera
Occupation	Accountant or actuary
Job Title	Rwanda Revenue Authority
Employment Status	Retired
Number of siblings	4
SIBLING 1 First Name	Sabin
Last Name	Butera
Education Level	Some college/university
Degree	Bachelor's (BA, BS)
College Name	University of Rwanda
Start Date	09/2022
End Date	09/2026
SIBLING 2 First Name	Aubin
Last Name	Butera Ishema
Education Level	Some college/university
Degree	Bachelor's (BA, BS)
College Name	Kigali Institute of Sciences and Technology
Start Date	09/2022

End Date	09/2026
SIBLING 3 First Name	Gabin
Last Name	Ituze
Education Level	Some high/secondary school
SIBLING 4 First Name	Gladys
Last Name	Muziranenge
Education Level	Some high/secondary school

Short Questions

Most significant challenge society faces

The world is in its puberty stage: AI advancements are proliferating, yet the knowledge of how to ethically use them and achieve optimal outcomes is lacking. Like a teenager full of strength but lacking the wisdom of age, our societies face the challenge of too much potential but low expertise.

Last two summers

In 2023, I started a small chicken business to help my younger brother pay school fees due to my father's income pause as he entered retirement.

In 2024, I was on a team initiating the Rwanda Informatics Olympiad. With sleepless nights preparing questions and mission plans, every struggle was rewarding.

Historical moment or event you'd like to witness

I wish I could have witnessed China's rise as a global economic power—to observe the strategies, principles, and decisions that inspired their rise to power. Understanding how they transformed limited resources to build generational wealth would give me insights for guiding Rwanda's journey toward sustainable growth and prosperity.

Extracurricular activity, job, or family responsibility

Realizing how few people support disabled children, I volunteered as a special needs school's teaching assistant, hoping to help a future "Stephen Hawking" thrive. By sharing these students' stories, I inspire others to create more equitable communities. My goal is to help one person maximize their potential and achieve greatness.

Five things that are important to you

My dreams for Rwanda are most important:

1. Inspiring innovation through Rwanda's heritage.

2. Building rural entrepreneur networks for sustainable enterprises.
 3. Providing affordable access to coding and STEM education in rural areas.
 4. Promoting regenerative agriculture for poverty eradication and food security.
 5. Creating global collaboration for Rwanda's solving.
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Short Essays

Idea or experience that makes you excited about learning

I think spending more than three days without writing a single line of code would make me sick, but how did this start? I wasn't born like this. It started when I was six; let me take you back.

What's that new light-emitting box, Mom? I asked. "Why don't you go check it out," she said. My tiny feet raced my brothers to see the mysterious box, a big Sony TV. Even then, I couldn't help but wonder: How did it work? What was the magic behind the glowing screen?

I had to start somewhere in finding answers to my questions about the T.V. This led me to experiment with mobile phones, dissect them, and watch tutorial videos. Through these endeavors, I developed a talent for fixing computer hardware.

At the age of thirteen, I repaired my dad's computer. Eager to share my achievement, I rushed to tell my friends, only to discover their disinterest in computers. Their indifference was a turning point, making me realize that my talents might lie in this unexplored realm. Intrigued, I wanted to learn more, moving from hardware repairs to studying programming and web development. I didn't know then I had discovered a passion that would fill me with the desire to learn daily.

Apart from my projects, I now participate in local tech meetups where we make technological startups to assist in smoothening services offered at Kagarama Sector's office.

Note to future roommate

First, if you ever hear someone reading *The Great Gatsby* aloud at 2 a.m., don't panic—it's just me. Silent reading feels like watching a movie on mute, so I turn every page into an Oscar-worthy monologue. Bonus points if you join in for dramatic effect.

Second, I have an almost unhealthy attachment to the *Harry Potter* series. I'm not just a fan—I'm the type who debates Dumbledore's ethics at breakfast and casually drops spells like "*Accio remote!*" when I can't find the TV remote. If you're not into it yet, don't worry—I have all seven books ready for our roommate book club (attendance: optional, but highly encouraged). We can even sort ourselves into Hogwarts houses—I'm a proud Gryffindor by the way.

Lastly, I notice everything. New haircut? I'll spot it. Cool socks? I'll compliment them. I might even say, "*Wow, your backpack matches your vibe today.*" Life's too short not to celebrate the little things.

Oh, and fair warning—I make a mean cup of tea, and I’m not above bribing you with it for deep late-night conversations. So, if you’re ready for late-night reading performances, Hogwarts debates, endless compliments, and occasional tea-fueled heart-to-hearts—let’s do this, roommate

Life experiences, interests and character that would help you make a distinctive contribution to Stanford

It was a quiet afternoon at Byimana when I saw two younger students looking at a quantum chessboard, their faces showing deep thought. They were confused about what move to make, and I could see they were getting frustrated. I went over, not to give them the answer, but to ask a question: 'What happens if you think five moves ahead?'

That moment reminded me why I started the Byimana Quantum Chess Club: not just to play a game but to create a place where curiosity could grow. We didn't have the newest technology or resources, but we had creativity. Together, we created an online platform that simulated chess situations, letting students all over Rwanda play, learn, and dream bigger.

Chess has always been, for me, a reflection of how I live my life: thinking ahead, accepting uncertainty, believing that every little move helps in forming a larger plan. As I stood up to speak before my class—strategies I had been working on for months—came the realisation that knowledge isn't for yourself alone; it is meant to be shared. Each lesson shared felt like a tiny victory for each of them; each moment of understanding brought a silent victory to each of them.

At Stanford, I want to continue to ask myself what comes next—not just for me, but for my friends, my country, and the world. Whether through computer science, finance, or creating something new, I want to make every move count and inspire others to do the same.

Additional Background

Have you ever been found responsible for a disciplinary violation at any educational institution you have attended from the 9th grade (or the international equivalent) forward, whether related to academic misconduct or behavioral misconduct, that resulted in a disciplinary action?	No
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Affirmations

I confirm that I understand and agree to uphold the spirit and letter of the Stanford Honor Code and Fundamental Standard.

I confirm that I understand and agree to uphold the spirit and letter of the Stanford Honor Code and Fundamental Standard.

**STANFORD
UNIVERSITY RESERVES
THE RIGHT TO
WITHDRAW YOUR
OFFER OF ADMISSION**

IF: 1) you show a significant drop in academic performance or fail to graduate; 2) there has been a misrepresentation in the application process; 3) we learn that you have engaged in behavior prior to the first day of enrolled attendance that indicates a serious lack of judgment or integrity; 4) you alter your class/course schedule without prior approval from the Office of Undergraduate Admission; or 5) you are holding a place, past May 1, in the freshman class of a college other than Stanford. Further, Stanford reserves the right to require the applicant to provide additional information (and/or authorization for the release of information) about any such matter. Stanford also reserves the right in perpetuity to investigate the authenticity, accuracy, and authorship of materials submitted, information provided, and assertions made in connection with the application.

Mobile Phone Contact

I certify that the information submitted in these application materials is current, complete and correct, and is my own work. I further understand and agree to the terms of the Stanford application instructions as posted at admission.stanford.edu, or as stated above, including Stanford's policies on the submission of the credentials noted above.

I understand that those involved in the Stanford admission process may need to contact me at a mobile number provided in the Common App.

CONSENT TO PRIVACY POLICY By submitting this application, I hereby consent to Stanford University's collection and processing of any sensitive personal data contained in my application to evaluate my application for the other purposes described in Stanford University's Online Privacy, Offline Privacy Policy, and the Privacy Notice for Admissions and Financial Aid which can be found at privacy.stanford.edu.

I hereby consent to Stanford University's collection and processing of any sensitive personal data contained in my application.

Affirmations

By submitting this application, I affirm my understanding of and agreement to the statements found here: <http://www.commonapp.org/affirmations>.